

Emotional Intelligence & Customer Excellence



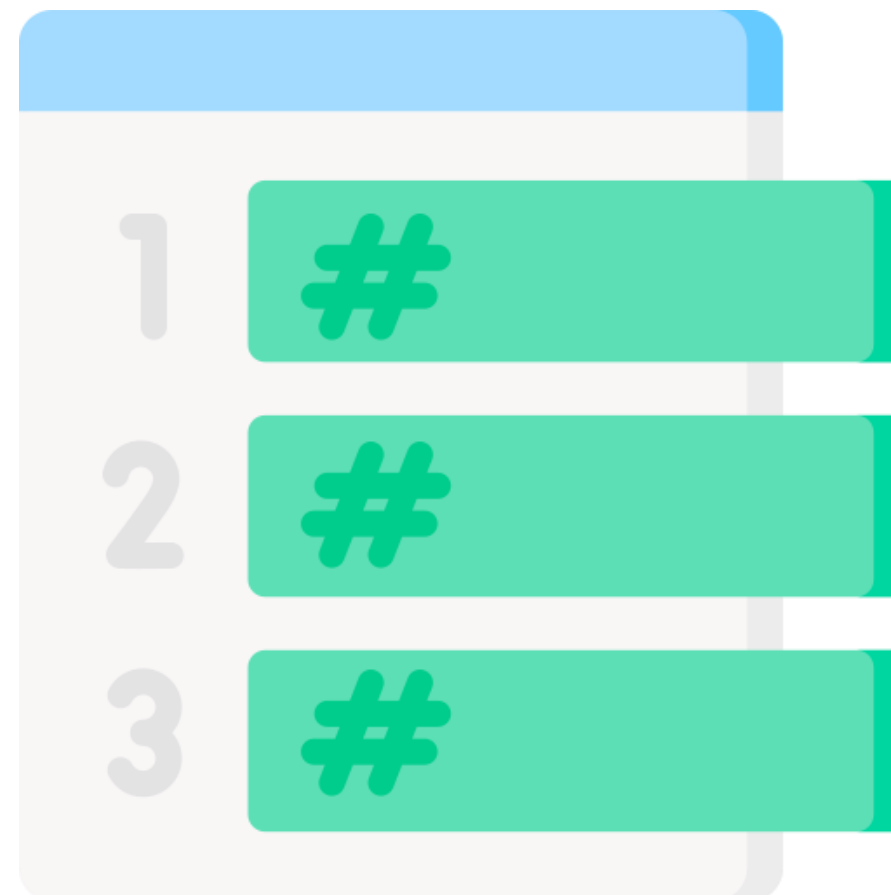
What you will be able to do

Understand EQ. Create a better reply.

- 1 Define emotional intelligence and its five components.
- 2 Explain how EQ differs from IQ—and why it matters for freelancers.
- 3 Use self-regulation techniques to manage emotions at work.
- 4 Tell client personalities apart and choose the right approach.
- 5 Judge and craft empathetic replies, including reviewed AI drafts.

Key topics covered:

- What is Emotional Intelligence (EQ)?
- Self-Awareness — know what you feel
- Self-Regulation — manage what you feel
- AI Activity 1 — Reframe It with AI
- Self-Motivation — keep yourself moving
- Empathy — understand what others feel
- Social Skills — handle relationships well
- AI Activity 2 — The Empathy Draft Duel



Warm-up — notice the moment

Do you usually notice your emotions right as they happen?

A

In the moment

B

A few minutes later

C

Only when I reflect

D

I am not sure yet

What is Emotional Intelligence (EQ)?

EQ is the ability to recognise, understand and manage your own emotions—and to read and respond to others. It is learnable.

RECOGNISE

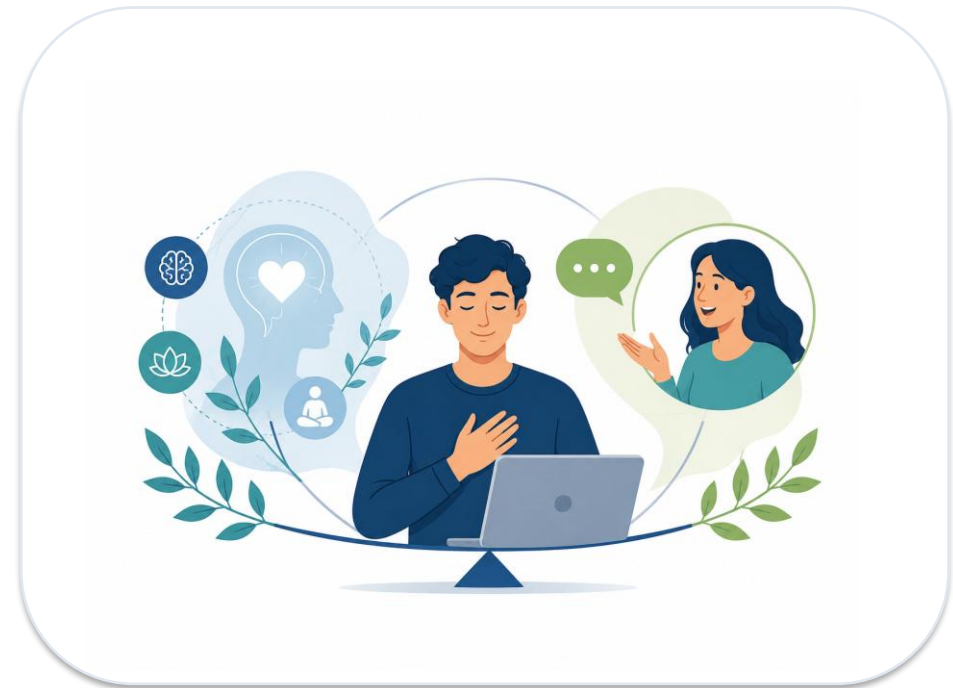
Notice your own emotions before they drive the reaction.

UNDERSTAND

Understand what emotions mean in yourself and others.

MANAGE

Manage your response so it serves the goal and relationship.



EQ vs IQ

Two different kinds of smart—you need both, but EQ is what clients feel.

IQ

Intelligence Quotient

- Knowledge and memory
- Expertise and critical thinking
- Logic and reasoning

What you know

EQ

Emotional Quotient

- Manage emotions
- Build empathy
- Strengthen self-control

What clients feel

Why are Emotional Intelligence Skills Important



The 5 components of EQ



Self-awareness

Know what you feel



Self-regulation

Manage what you feel



Self-motivation

Keep yourself moving



Empathy

Understand what others feel



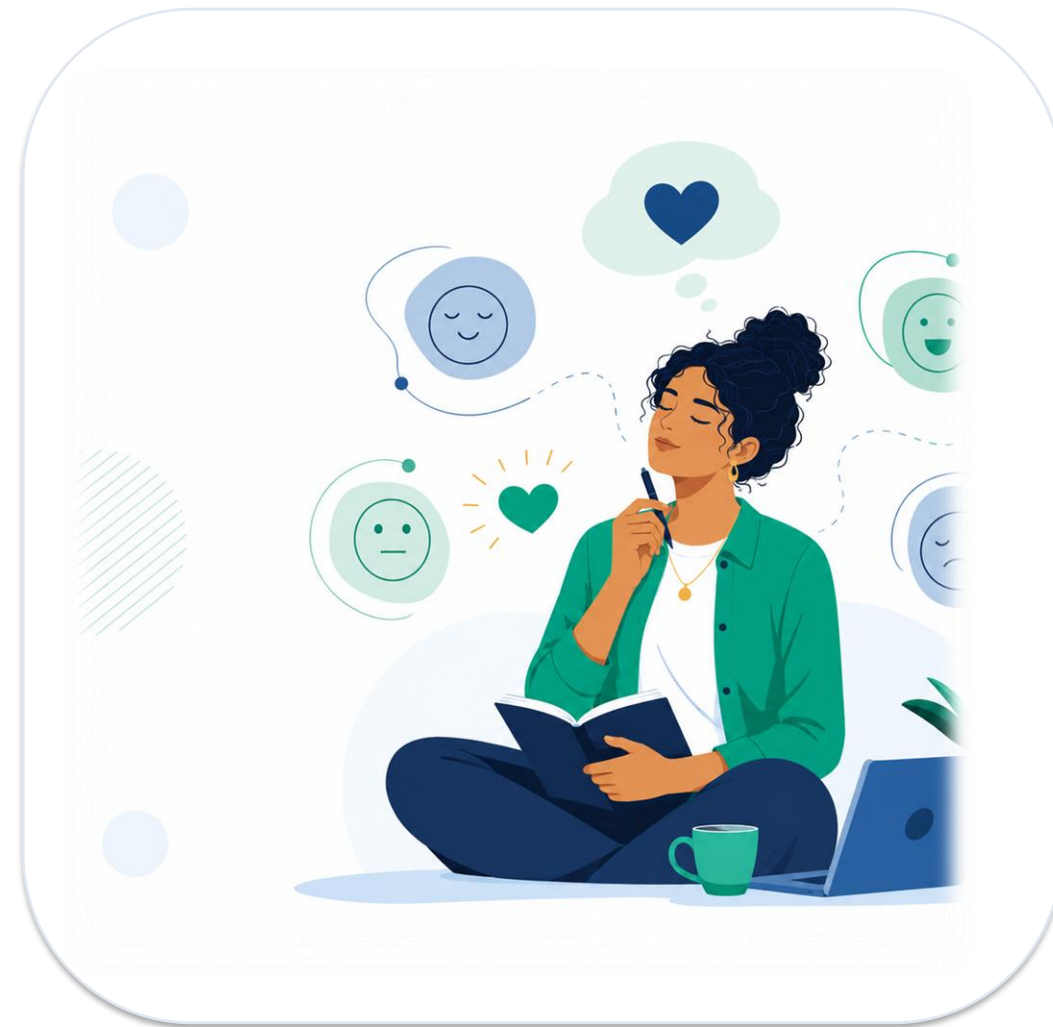
Social skills

Handle relationships well

Let's Play!



Self-Awareness



What are emotions?

Emotions are signals. Naming them precisely is the first step to managing them.

SIGNAL

Every emotion carries useful information.

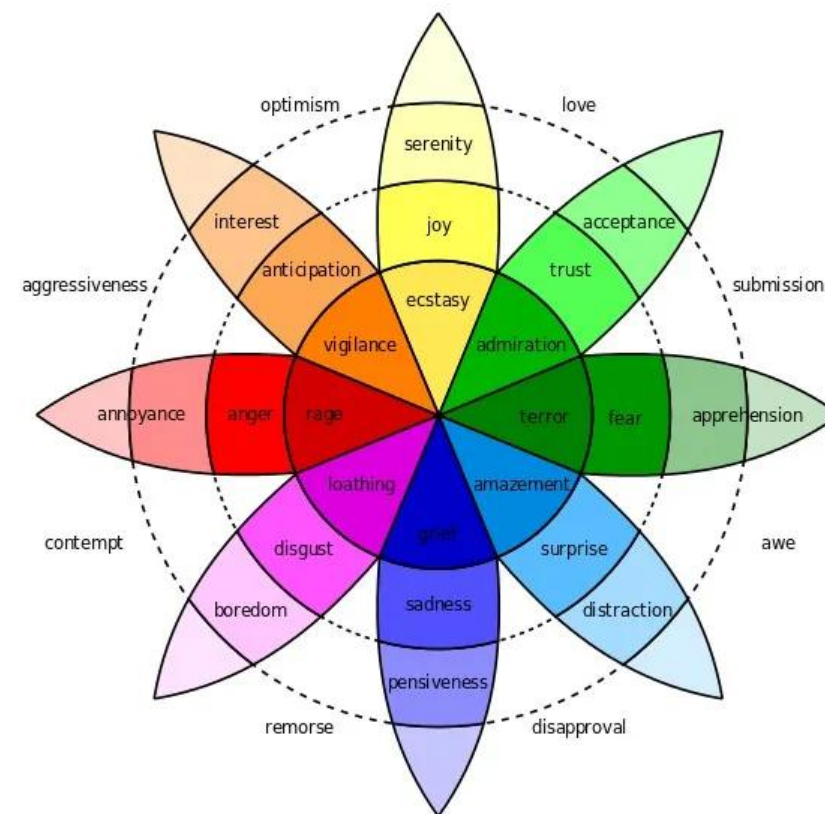
NAME

Move past “good” or “bad” to the precise feeling.

CONTROL

Precise naming gives you more choice over what happens next.

SELF-AWARENESS



Building self-awareness

Four simple habits you can start today.

1

PAUSE + NAME

Name the feeling before
you react.

2

BODY SIGNALS

Notice a tight jaw, fast
heartbeat or clenched
hands.

3

TRACK TRIGGERS

Which situations set you
off—and why?

4

ASK

What is this emotion
trying to tell me?

Self-Regulation



What is self-regulation?

The ability to control behaviour, emotions and thoughts in pursuit of your goals. In one line: think before you act.

EMOTIONS

Recognise what you feel and lower the intensity.

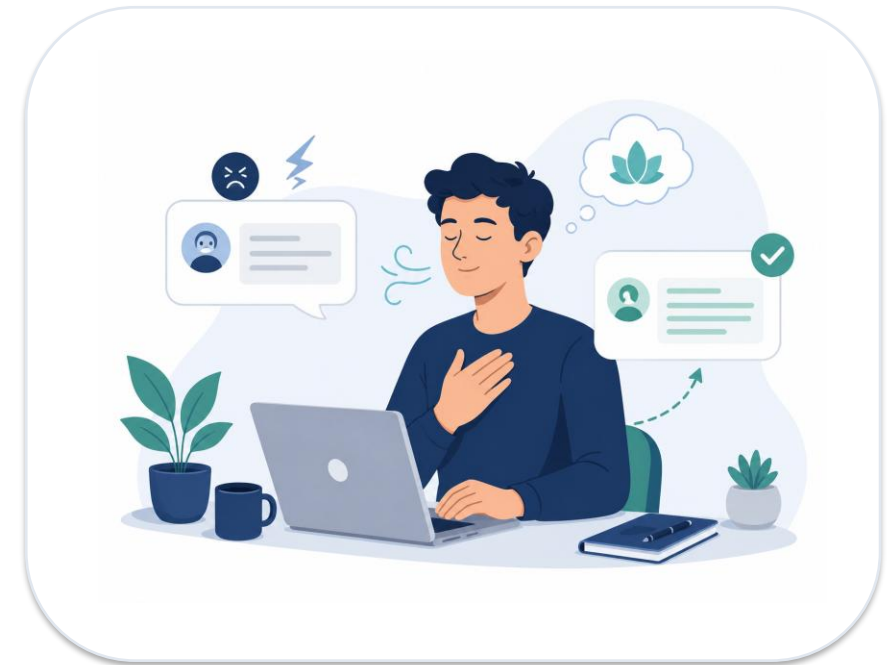
BEHAVIOUR

Direct actions so they align with your goals and the situation.

THOUGHTS

Use the pause to think before you act.

SELF-REGULATION



Two kinds of self-regulation

— We manage both what we feel and what we do.

E

Emotional self-regulation

- Recognise emotions as they arise
- Understand what triggers them
- Find healthy ways to cope

WHAT YOU FEEL

B

Behavioural self-regulation

- Control the visible action
- Match tone to the situation
- Keep behaviour aligned with goals

WHAT YOU DO

How to regulate emotions

MINDFULNESS

Deliberately notice thoughts and feelings without judging them—so they no longer run the show.



POSITIVE REAPPRAISAL

Change how you interpret the event to reduce its emotional impact and see it more usefully.

Which technique would help most before a difficult reply?

Business situations — what would you do?

Apply self-regulation to two everyday freelance moments.

01

In a client meeting, they provoke you with some negative, dismissive words.

PAUSE • REFRAME

02

Someone posts negative feedback about your work publicly on social media.

ACKNOWLEDGE • MOVE OFFLINE

PRACTICE

AI Activity 1 — Reframe It with AI



AI EMOTION COACH

Think with AI. Decide for
yourself.

1

Choose one real, mildly stressful work message.

2

Ask AI to name the emotion and offer two balanced views.

3

Ask for a calm, professional reply you could send.

4

Judge the output; refine the prompt and make it sound like you.

Use anonymized details only. Never send an AI reply unread.

Copy / paste prompt — Reframe It with AI

PROMPT

Here is a work message that frustrated me: [PASTE ANONYMIZED MESSAGE].

- 1) Name the main emotion I may be feeling.
- 2) Suggest two realistic, balanced interpretations—without excusing poor behaviour.
- 3) Draft a short professional reply in a calm, direct tone.
- 4) Keep it factual; do not invent promises.

REVIEW: Does the reframe feel true? Refine with “warmer”, “firmer”, or “keep my tone”. Edit the final reply before sending.

Self-Motivation



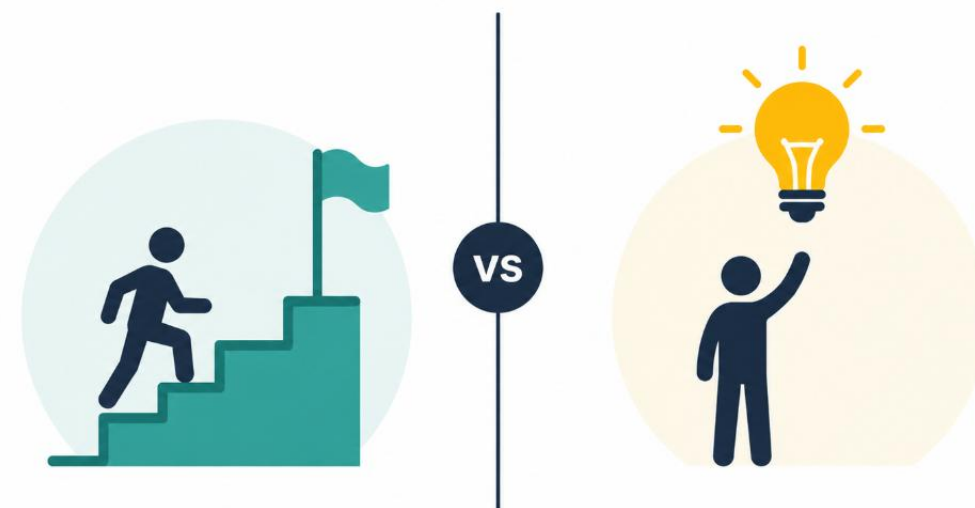
Motivation vs inspiration

Motivation

Motivation is what pushes us to achieve our goals, feel more fulfilled, and improve our overall quality of life. It is your why that keeps you moving.

Inspiration

Inspiration is the spark that ignites a new idea or goal. However, the thing about that spark is it doesn't last.



Quick self-check

1

NAME IT
Which emotion is
hardest to notice?

2

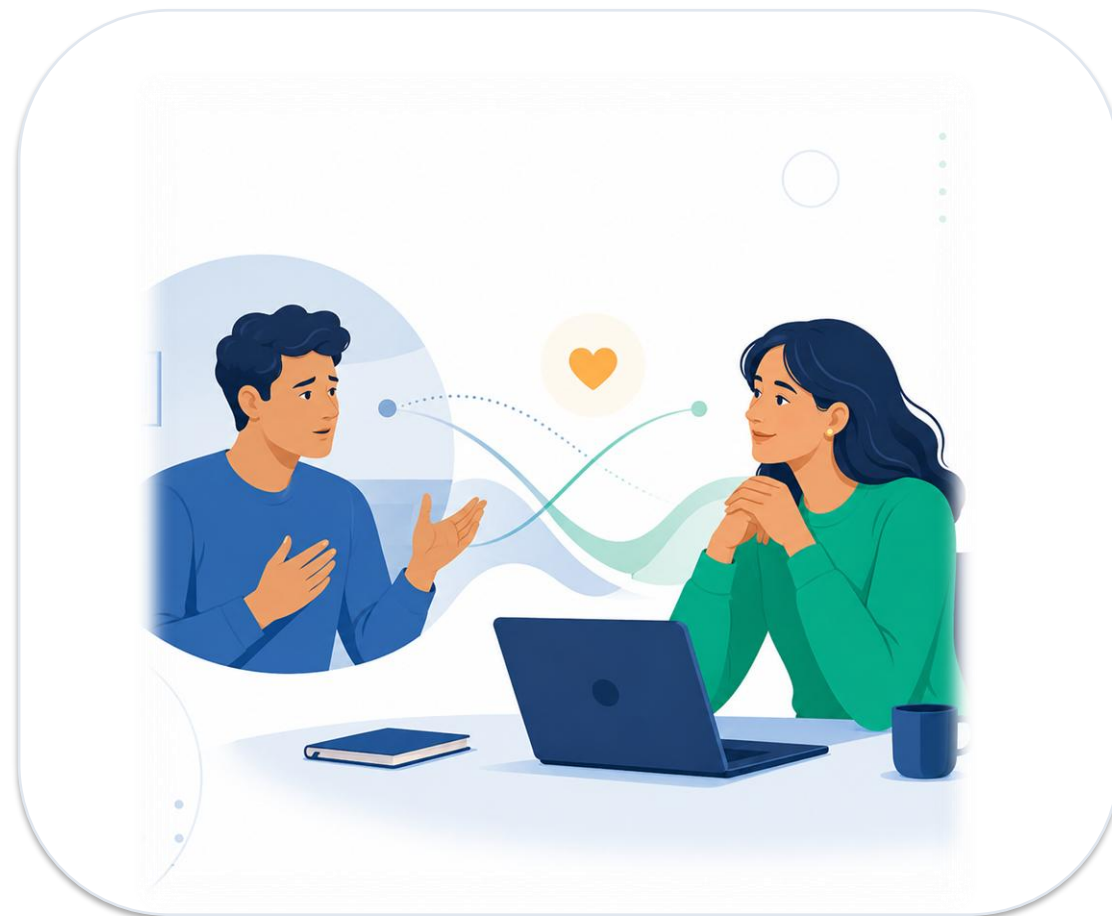
PAUSE IT
When did pausing
help?

3

DRIVE IT
What “why” keeps
you motivated?

Answer in the chat or your notebook.

Empathy



What is empathy?

Empathy is the ability to understand and share the feelings and thoughts of others.

UNDERSTAND

Step into someone else's shoes—and see from there.

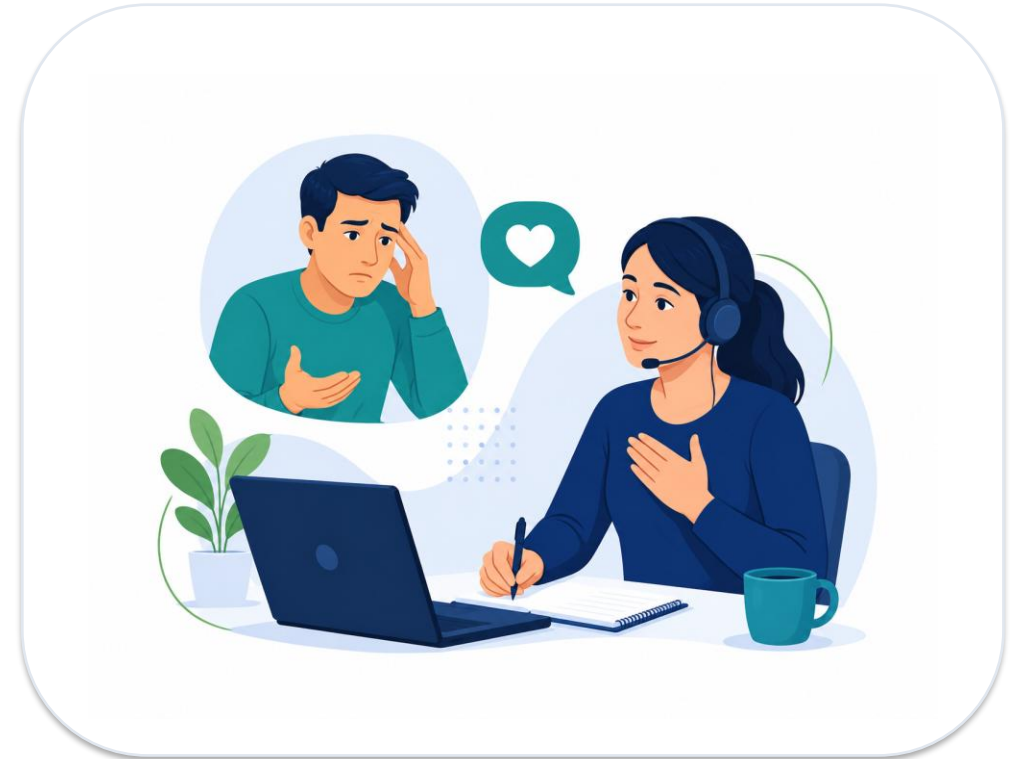
SHARE

Notice feelings and thoughts without taking them over.

CONNECT

Genuine compassion supports every people skill that follows.

EMPATHY



Empathy & handling clients

“

"Deal with others in their frame of reference — not yours."

Identify the client's situation and feelings first. As a freelancer, empathy is needed at every step — dealing with clients, their pressure and their deadlines.

How to practise empathy

1

WATCH

Notice tone, pauses
and word choice.

2

LISTEN

Give full attention. Do
not plan your reply.

3

UNDERSTAND

See where they are
coming from.

4

ASK

Questions beat
assumptions every
time.

AI Activity 2 — The Empathy Draft Duel



**YOU
VS AI**

Draft first. Then compare.

1

Write your own empathetic reply first.

2

Ask AI to reply to the same anonymized message.

3

Score both drafts against four empathy checks.

4

Combine the strongest lines into one reply you would send.

AI drafts fast. You evaluate, personalise and create the final reply.

Copy / paste prompt — Empathy Draft Duel

COPY / PASTE

A client sent me this message: [PASTE ANONYMIZED MESSAGE].

Draft an empathetic, professional reply that:

- 1) acknowledges their feeling,
- 2) uses their point of view,
- 3) sets one clear expectation, and
- 4) stays professional.

Keep it under 120 words.

Score both. Edit the winner. No invented facts.

Social Skills



The social skills you need

01

Communication
share ideas clearly and listen well.

02

Teamwork & collaboration
work smoothly with clients and partners.

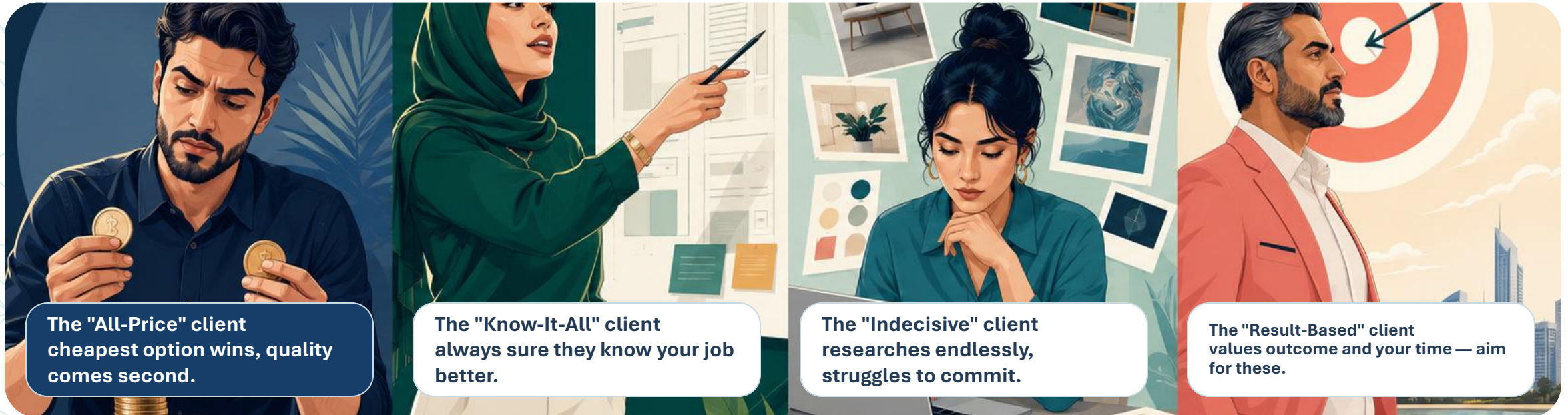
03

Persuasion & influence
bring people around to good ideas.

04

Conflict management
handle disagreement without damage.

Handling clients as a freelancer



The “All-Price” client

HOW TO SPOT THEM

"Can you do it for less?"
"My cousin does this for a fraction of the price."
"Tell me the cost first, before anything else."

HOW TO DEAL WITH THEM

Price is everything to them and quality comes second. If their budget and your minimum are far apart, there is little room to negotiate. Stay calm, state your value briefly, and if it is not a fit, refer them on politely rather than dropping your rate.



The “Know-It-All” client

HOW TO SPOT THEM

"It is easy, I could do it myself in an hour."
"I will write the script, you just follow it."
"This should be quick and simple, right?"

HOW TO DEAL WITH THEM

They want to be heavily involved and advise even outside their expertise. Do not argue - embrace what they say, then gently educate: explain the real process and time behind the work, hold your value, and set clear expectations. Offer options and let them choose, keeping your composure throughout.

CUSTOMER TYPES



The “Indecisive” client

HOW TO SPOT THEM

"Let me think about it / check with my partner."

"I am just asking for now, not ready to buy."

"Let me compare a few other freelancers first."

HOW TO DEAL WITH THEM

They research a lot before committing - educate them well and it can pay off. Invite them to shop around and contact you last, position yourself honestly as a higher-value option, and avoid diving into detailed pricing until they are clear on what they actually want.



Results-based client

HOW TO SPOT THEM

"I trust you - just get it done well."

"I will not micromanage each detail."

"I care about the outcome more than the price."

HOW TO DEAL WITH THEM

These are the clients to aim for: they value your time and the result over cost. Use value-based pricing, act as an advisor and problem-solver rather than just an operator, and focus your energy on quality and progress. They often bring more work and better referrals.



Creating customer delight

Six habits that turn a satisfied client into a loyal one.

CLEAR START

Set clear expectations early.

COMMUNICATION

Emphasise open communication;
manage clients closely and honestly.

TRANSPARENCY

Build trust through transparency.

SUPPORT + RECORDS

Give strong support and security;
maintain thorough records.

CUSTOMER DELIGHT



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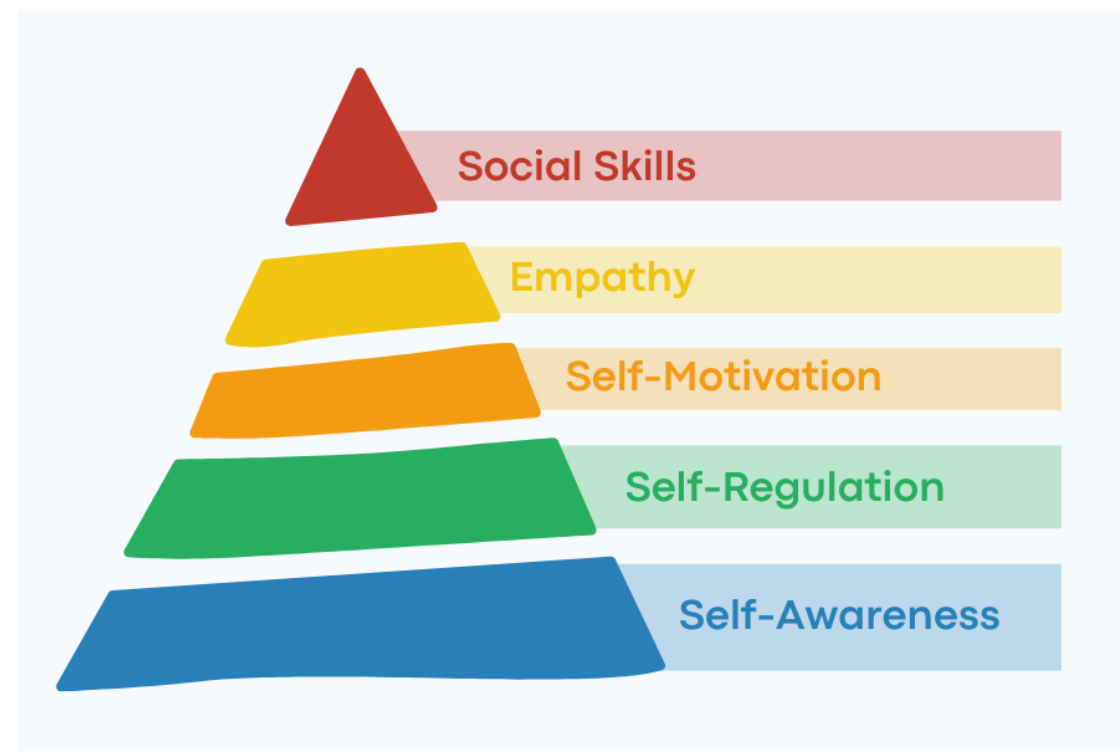
**"CEOs are hired for their intellect and business expertise —
and fired for a lack of emotional intelligence."**

Daniel Goleman

Recap



Plus: reframe stress with AI + draft empathetic client replies.



Thank you for your participation

